Lesson 21

MODERATION

Aim: To present a balanced Christian Life through the principle of moderation.

Intro:

A well known Bible teacher once said, " Truth pushed too far becomes an error". This statement carries a powerful truth that needs a serious consideration by all Christians. We have heard of many cases of extreme and fanatical practices of some Christians that bring reproach and shame to the Name of Christ, rather than the glory to His Name. Well meaning Christians can avoid these pitfall only if they learn the principle of moderation.

I. **What is the Meaning of Moderation?**

A. It means that the experience and daily walk of a believer should never lead him to extremes, fanaticism, unseemly manifestations, backbitings and murmurings.

B. Positively, it means being sober, thoughtful, balanced, mellow, forgiving, steadfast, humble, self - sacrificing and Christlike.

II. Biblical Basis of the Principle of Moderation

A. Philippians 4:5 - **5** Let your gentleness be evident to all. The Lord is near.

B. Ephesians 4:14-15 - **14** Then we will no longer be infants, tossed back and forth by the waves, and blown here and there by every wind of teaching and by the cunning and craftiness of people in their deceitful scheming.**15** Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will grow to become in every respect the mature body of him who is the head, that is, Christ.

C. 1 Corinthians 13:5 - **5** It does not dishonor others, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no record of wrongs.

D. Colossians 3:12,13 - **12** Therefore, as God's chosen people, holy and dearly loved, clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness and patience.

III. Areas where we can Apply Moderation

A. Spiritual gifts

B. Doctrines

C. Religious Observance

D. Personal preference

E. Habits

F. Personal Liberty

G. Temperament

Conclusion

Our life as a Christian will become balanced, wholesome, and well - rounded if we apply the principles of Moderation.